

BACKGROUND GUIDE

GAC: Battle of the Alamo

TEXAN SIDE

LANGUAGE

ENGLISH

FORMAT

INDIVIDUAL

DEPUTY UNDER-SECRETARIAT-GENERAL

CRISIS



MONUA XVI

UNIVERSIDAD DE LOS ANDES MODEL UNITED NATIONS

The Universidad de los Andes Model United Nations (MONUA) is an academic conference organized by students of Universidad de los Andes with the support of the Faculty of Social Sciences. Throughout more than fifteen editions, MONUA has established itself as a distinguished forum where secondary school and university students from Colombia and around the world come together to engage in diplomacy, debate, and the collaborative development of solutions to contemporary global challenges.

Through the representation of Member States, international organizations, institutions, and other relevant actors, participants research, negotiate, deliberate, and collaborate on political, social, economic, legal, and humanitarian issues. Beyond competition, MONUA is an educational experience designed to strengthen critical thinking, public speaking, leadership, empathy, and respect for diverse perspectives.

Inclusion and social responsibility remain fundamental pillars of the conference. Through initiatives such as Learning with MONUA, MONUA Fellowship, and other educational programs, MONUA seeks to make diplomacy, negotiation, and leadership opportunities accessible to children and young people from a wide variety of backgrounds.

Under the theme #EmpoweringEveryVoice, MONUA XVI reaffirms its commitment to creating spaces where every participant can contribute, learn, and advocate for their ideas through academic excellence, mutual respect, and international cooperation.

This edition will feature educational committees, United Nations bodies, specialized and legal committees, crisis cabinets, as well as media and interconnectivity committees. These Background Guides are intended to serve as the starting point for delegates' research, while the MONUA XVI Handbook outlines the conference's Rules of Procedure, code of conduct, and general policies.

MONUA XVI invites every participant to exchange ideas, embrace new perspectives, overcome challenges, and develop solutions that extend beyond the committee room. Each Background Guide has been carefully prepared to support delegates throughout their research process and to provide the foundation for informed, rigorous, and responsible participation.

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Welcome Letters

Board of Directors · Senior Staff · Committee Dais

Opening messages from the members of the Board of Directors, Senior Staff, and Committee Dais, whose leadership, commitment, and dedication make MONUA XVI possible.



Secretary-General

Salome Rodríguez Ballesteros

s.rodriquezb2345@uniandes.edu.co

Dear Participants of MONUA XVI,

If you are reading this letter, it means you are about to embark on an experience that I am certain will leave a lasting impact on you in many ways. Beyond debates, position papers, and resolutions, MONUA is a place to learn from others, discover new perspectives, and appreciate the value of diplomacy, dialogue, and cooperation.

My name is Salome Rodríguez Ballesteros, and it is my great honor to welcome you this year as the Secretary-General of MONUA XVI. I am currently pursuing a degree in Global Studies and Political Science, with concentrations in International Law and Economics. Like many of you, I found in Model United Nations a place where I learned that words, when used with respect and purpose, have the power to transform realities. I remember exactly what it feels like to arrive at your first conference with a mixture of excitement, uncertainty, and high expectations. I also remember the thrill of delivering my first speech, meeting extraordinary people, and realizing that these experiences are not about always being right, but about being willing to listen, learn, and grow. That is the experience I hope each of you will have at MONUA XVI.

Whether this is your very first conference or you have participated in many before, every committee is a new opportunity to challenge yourself, step outside your comfort zone, and discover abilities you may not yet know you possess. Do not hesitate to raise your placard, defend your ideas with respect, and build bridges even when differences arise. After all, that is what the United Nations stands for, and it is the spirit we strive to cultivate at MONUA. I want you to know that this edition has been prepared with great care by a team that truly believes in the transformative impact of these experiences. My greatest hope is that, when MONUA XVI comes to an end, you will leave with far more than an award or a certificate. I hope you leave with lasting friendships, meaningful lessons, and the confidence to continue using your voice wherever life takes you.

Thank you for placing your trust in us and for being part of this edition. I hope you enjoy every debate, every conversation, and every moment throughout the conference. I am confident that this experience will be only the beginning of many great things to come.

With my warmest regards,

Salome Rodríguez Ballesteros

Secretary-General

MONUA XVI – Universidad de Los Andes



Academic Secretary

Juliana Solano Sossa

j.solanos2@uniandes.edu.co

Dear delegates, sponsors, staff members, and all those whom it may concern,

My name is Juliana Solano, and I have the honor of serving as the Academic Secretary of MONUA XVI. I am currently in my eighth semester of Law and am pursuing a double degree in Business Administration at Universidad de los Andes. Throughout my journey in Model United Nations, I have found in these spaces not only a setting for rigorous academic training, but also a project that has allowed me to grow, challenge myself, and build a community of which I have felt deeply proud since the very first moment I became a part of it.

Today, I would like to warmly welcome you to this conference. We are truly delighted that you have decided to take on this challenge and become part of this edition. MONUA is not only a place to learn theory, debate, or refine argumentative skills—which are undoubtedly fundamental—but also a space to build experiences, create genuine connections, and discover the potential that each and every one of you possesses. My invitation is for you to approach this process not only with discipline, but also with intention and dedication. Allow yourselves to go beyond what is expected, to question, propose, and build. Take advantage of every debate, every intervention, and every interaction as an opportunity for growth. I hope this conference will be a space that challenges you academically, while also leaving a mark on you personally. May you find here not only a stage on which to excel, but also a place to share, make friends, and enjoy the process.

Welcome to MONUA XVI.

With my full commitment to accompany you throughout this process,

Juliana Solano Sossa
Academic Secretary
MONUA XVI



Director-General

Samir David Fernández Yunis

s.fernandezy@uniandes.edu.co

Dear Participants, welcome to the sixteenth edition of MONUA.

My name is Samir David Fernández Yunis, and it is my pleasure to serve as the Director-General of MONUA XVI. I am currently in my seventh semester of Electronic Engineering at Universidad de los Andes, and for several years, Model United Nations has been a fundamental part of my academic and personal journey. From my first conferences in high school to my experience in the university MUN circuit, these experiences have challenged me, helped me grow, and allowed me to understand the world through a wide range of perspectives.

Throughout this journey, I have come to understand that MUN is a space where ideas, interests, and worldviews that often seem irreconcilable come together. It is precisely within that diversity that the most meaningful experiences emerge. To disagree is not to confront one another, but rather to engage with ideas, institutions, and perspectives that deserve to be questioned with rigor, integrity, and respect. That is the spirit we strive to foster at MONUA. For this edition, we set ourselves a clear objective: to deliver a conference that meets the standards of the most competitive delegations in Colombia and the region while preserving the international character that defines MONUA. The participation of delegations from across Latin America not only elevates the quality of debate but also transforms this conference into a true academic and cultural meeting point.

Our goal is to offer a conference that is ambitious, thoughtfully designed, and carefully executed in every academic and logistical aspect. Beyond committees and debates, MONUA is an experience. I hope these four days become not only an intellectual challenge, but also an opportunity to meet remarkable people, build lasting connections, and discover your own potential. I would like to express my sincere gratitude to everyone who has made this project possible: our academic team, the Board of Directors, our staff, and each one of you for placing your trust in this process. MONUA exists because of this collective commitment, and I am confident that this edition will meet your expectations and leave you with far more than outstanding results—it will leave you with unforgettable experiences and lasting connections.

With respect and sincere regards,

Samir David Fernández Yunis
Director-General
MONUA XVI



Deputy Academic Secretary

Jose Alejandro Gutiérrez Cifuentes

ja.gutierrezc1@uniandes.edu.co

Dear Sponsors, Delegates, Observers, Staff Members, Parents, and Anyone Else Who Decided to Read This Letter,

Welcome to MONUA! A place to debate, to think, and—most importantly—to question.

My name is Jose Alejandro Gutiérrez Cifuentes, and for the sixteenth edition of MONUA, I am delighted to serve as the Deputy Academic Secretary of the conference.

I am currently pursuing a master's degree in Physics at Universidad de los Andes, and ever since I was young, I have loved movies, philosophy, and wonderfully terrible jokes. Somehow, all of those interests found a home in crisis committees, where I developed not only those passions but also the skills that have shaped the person I am today. Through MUN, I have learned to approach problems from multiple perspectives and to appreciate the value of interdisciplinary thinking.

Despite the many people who have tried to convince me that my academic background has little to do with Model United Nations, I have come to believe quite the opposite. When our goal is to pursue truth and strive to do things well, we cannot rely solely on the exact sciences. We also need the tools that dialogue, diplomacy, and debate provide. I hope this conference becomes, for you, what it has been for me: an opportunity to grow and, in our own small way, make the world a little better. I also hope that throughout this experience you find a space to collaborate with honesty, creativity, and an open mind, making the most of everything MONUA has to offer.

If this message resonates with even one person by the end of MONUA XVI, I will gladly quote two of my country's greatest icons with complete confidence: «There is something about Colombians: we never lose hope of doing better every single time,» and «We've lowered the ignorance levels just a tiny bit, professor,» by Jaime Garzón and La Cevichica, respectively.

Thank you, best of luck, and I'll see you at MONUA.

With warm regards,

Jose Alejandro Gutiérrez Cifuentes

Deputy Academic Secretary

MONUA XVI



Deputy Director-General

María José Penagos

mj.penagos@uniandes.edu.co

Dear delegates, sponsors, staff members, and everyone who is part of this story today: welcome to the sixteenth edition of MONUA!

My name is María José Penagos Granados, and I have the immense privilege of serving as the Deputy Secretary-General of MONUA XVI. I am currently pursuing a double major in Government and Public Affairs and Business Administration at Universidad de los Andes.

Ever since I was very young, Model United Nations has held a special place in my life. It taught me that ideas have the power to transform realities, that listening is just as important as speaking, and that true leadership is, above all, about creating opportunities for others to shine.

To me, MONUA is so much more than a conference. It is a place that inspires, challenges, and transforms. It is where people from different backgrounds and perspectives come together and discover that dialogue will always be more powerful than division, and that the most meaningful solutions emerge when we choose to build them together. I truly believe that change begins with those who dare to participate, to question, and to believe they can make a difference.

Thank you for placing your trust in this project and for choosing to be part of this edition. Behind every detail is a team that has worked with dedication, enthusiasm, and genuine care to create an unforgettable experience for all of you. I hope you will feel that commitment in every committee, every debate, and every moment you share throughout these days.

I encourage you to embrace MONUA with enthusiasm and generosity. Make the most of every speech, every hallway conversation, and every person you have the chance to meet. Allow yourselves to learn, to make mistakes, to grow, and to be surprised. Don't be afraid to raise your placard, stand up for your ideas, or listen openly to perspectives that challenge your own.

When MONUA XVI comes to an end, I hope you leave with far more than wonderful memories. I hope you take home lasting friendships, lessons that will stay with you for years to come, and the certainty that each of you has the power to create a positive impact. This conference is now yours—embrace it with curiosity, conviction, and an open heart.

With warmth, respect, and admiration,
María José Penagos Granados
Deputy Director-General MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

Deputy Under-Secretary-General



USG

CRISIS

Samuel Escallón

samrodriguezes@unal.edu.co

Hello everyone, I'm Samuel Escallón, though in this world I'm better known as Esca. I'm a Political Science student at the National University of Colombia, and I'll be one of your SGAs for this edition of MONUA.

For better or worse, I'll be your SGA for one more edition (hopefully the last), and the main reason I'm returning to the project isn't the sponsorships, the social events they organize, or the quality of the buildings at the Andes (God forbid I ever have to go back to the Lleras building). I'm really coming back for the people involved in this project. It was thanks to them that last year's edition was such a special event in my life, and my invitation in this letter (if you read it) is to let yourselves be impacted and surprised by the people around you on this adventure. Because beyond the friends, partners, almost-somethings, almost-nothings, almos, petals, secret flings, shadows, or crushes we already have in our lives, a space to connect with people from different universities, or even from various countries in our Americas, awaits us this coming cold August at the most special Model United Nations in Colombia.

And well, you already know the rest: I don't know how to ride a bike, if God, the Virgin Mary, and the elections allow me, I may graduate at the end of this year, and don't let the fear of making mistakes hold you back, because the most valuable lessons come from those mistakes.

Warm regards, and I hope to see you soon.

Att. Esca

MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

Deputy Under-Secretary-General



USG

CRISIS

David Ramírez

d.ramirezg23@uniandes.edu.co

Hello everyone!

I'm David Ramírez, although most people call me El Tino. I'm somewhere between my 4th and 6th semester of Business Administration at Universidad de los Andes, even though I spend my time doing pretty much everything except studying that degree. I'm happy to announce that I'll be one of your SGAs for this edition of MONUA!

A little more about me: I'm a die-hard fan of the best team in Colombian football, the glorious Deportes Tolima. Hopefully this year we won't bottle either the league or the Copa Libertadores. I also enjoy beer, playing the guitar, finance, beer (yes, it deserves to be mentioned twice), and I can't breathe underwater.

For this edition of the conference, I hope you allow yourselves to be surprised and, above all, that each of you explores and develops your creativity to the fullest—because that's exactly what Crisis is all about. I remember joining Crisis because of a friend who claims he's a physicist. Honestly, I think he just likes to show off the degree; in reality, he probably spends all his time figuring out how to make Tolima win without making us suffer. But joining Crisis ended up being one of the best experiences I've ever had, and I hope that for many of you—whether this is your first model or your «last» one (although, let's be honest, there's really no such thing as a last model in this world; you always end up coming back)—you'll discover that same passion for debating, delegating, and letting your imagination run free.

Without anything else to add, I hope you enjoy this edition, may God and the Virgin watch over you, may you learn from your mistakes, and above all, may you be happy.

Att. Tino
MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

GAC: Battle of the Alamo



Chair

Ana Sofia Camargo Avila

anacamargoa@javeriana.edu.co

Good afternoon, dear delegates. I hope you are all doing well. My name is Ana Sofia Camargo Avila; I am 20 years old and currently in my seventh semester of International Relations at Pontificia Universidad Javeriana. It is a great pleasure to be with you as part of your Dais, and I hope that together with Mariana, we can help them, we can support you and ensure this committee's success.

I hope the academic guide we are preparing proves helpful for your preparation for this great committee and, more importantly, for the winning side of this GAC. I look forward to meeting you all at the opening ceremony. Should you have any questions, concerns, or wish to contact us, please feel free to reach out via this email. And remember: we are looking for the best soldiers to fight for our Texan land.

Ana Sofia Camargo Avila
Chair of GAC: Texan Side
MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

GAC: Battle of the Alamo



Hello, dear delegates! I am pleased to be joining you in this journey as a part of your DAIS on the Texan side. My name is Mariana Quintero Mora, but you can call me Mari. I just graduated from a career in Literary Studies and am currently in my first semester of a Master's in Education at Universidad Nacional de Colombia. As you can see I can be very ambitious and I like to put that energy into everything I do.

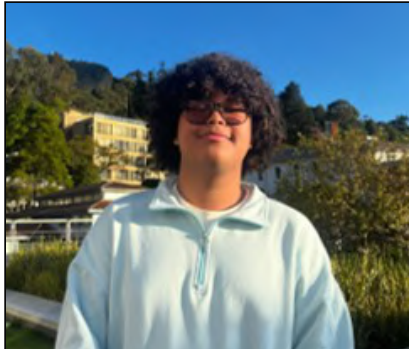
I am committed to making this GAC a joyful and nurturing experience for all of you and in return I expect you to give it your best effort so that we can be the winning side. I hope we can grow and learn together as a team but as individuals as well, I find that the abilities you strengthen in crisis committees have a way of being useful in day to day life, so my advice to you is that you make the most of this.

If you have any doubts or issues please contact us, both me and Ana are very open to communication and we want you to feel like you can talk to us if you need to so that this can be the best possible situation for all of us.

Mariana Quintero Mora
Chair of GAC: Texan Side
MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

GAC: Battle of the Alamo



Center Director

Nicolás Camacho Díaz

ncamachod@unal.edu.co

Hello everyone, my name is Nicolás Camacho, known as NikoWaa or Toñito to my friends. I'm 20 years old and a sixth-semester student of Political Science and Literary Studies at the National University of Colombia.

This time, I'll have the pleasure of being one of your Center Co-Directors, and I hope to give each of you a meaningful experience in delegation, creating a space where you can develop all the skills a crisis committee can bring to the forefront, and even some you might not know you possess. Please know that I'll always be available to answer your questions about the committee and your well-being, as this should be the most important thing for you to have a rewarding experience during the model.

From myself and the team, I promise that we will do our best to meet your expectations, giving our full commitment and effort to successfully carry out the committee; even if that doesn't happen, at least there will be plenty of laughs during the updates and the final verdict.

Nicolás Camacho Díaz
Strategy Center Director
MONUA XVI

WELCOME LETTERS

GAC: Battle of the Alamo



Center Director

Kevin Alejandro Páez Ramírez

kepaezr@unal.edu.co

Good morning, good afternoon, or good evening, everyone!

My name is Kevin Alejandro Páez Ramírez, though you can simply call me Kev. I am 22 years old and currently studying Sociology at the Universidad Nacional de Colombia.

For this edition of MONUA, I am delighted to join you as a Co-Center Director. I hope we share an unforgettable experience filled with laughter, engaging discussions, and opportunities for you to put your skills as delegates to the test. Of course, I will always be available to answer your questions and help ensure that you have an enjoyable and rewarding committee experience. Our goal is to create a space where you can unleash your creativity while maintaining the academic rigor that defines MONUA.

We hope that MONUA XVI will be an experience you truly enjoy, and that the Battle of the Alamo lives up to its name.

Kevin Alejandro Páez Ramírez
Strategy Center Director
MONUA XVI

Section

Preamble

■ How does this committee work?

Crisis committees are special committees where different types of situations are simulated, including historical, economic, political, military, or even futuristic or fantasy scenarios. Within these committees, delegates can take both group and individual actions to achieve the objective of their faction or the committee as a whole, as well as the individual objective of each character. They manage the various crises or updates that arrive in response to the actions taken in order to either energize or complicate the committee's development. These updates are generated by a strategy center, which is responsible for guiding the committee through the different challenges and reporting the results of the events and actions taken, both individually and collectively by the committee.

Crisis committees are composed of one or more cabinets and a strategy center.

1. **Cabinets:** Cabinets are composed of delegates representing different roles. Their purpose is to work together to achieve the cabinet's collective objective, as well as their individual objectives. This depends on whether the committee is designed to foster mutual support or, conversely, to operate in an internal competition, where each delegate's individual objective determines the committee's direction and the repercussions of their actions. These actions taken by the delegates are called directives, which can be public or private depending on the action's purpose. When these directives are reviewed, approved, or rejected by the board (public directives only) and the strategy center, they shape the committee's course and influence future crises.
2. **Strategy Center:** The strategy center is made up of various members of the academic staff acting as crisis managers and a center director. These directors are responsible for directing the actions of the agents and the evaluation of the directives and the impact they have on the committee, as well as designing the crisis arc to be followed during the days of the model.

Section

Committee Introduction

■ What is a GAC? What is this GAC about?

For this year's committee we present to you the conflict between Texan and federative armies against centralist Mexican forces trying to establish dominion in the disputed territories. Crisis Committees are committees formed by two cabinets, which typically compete for control of territories or strategic points in a war or conquest scenario, as in this case. Therefore, the objective of each cabinet is to outmaneuver or defeat the other.

The Battle of the Alamo is generally considered to have taken place from February 23 to March 6, 1836, and is symbolically interpreted as the search for solutions to a profound constitutional crisis within the Mexican Republic through military means. The conflict occurred during the transition from the federalist system, established by the Constitution of 1824 (Mexico's first independent constitution), to the centralist dictatorship imposed by Antonio López de Santa Anna through the Seven Laws of 1835, thus triggering a civil war in which each side interpreted one of these ideologies.

We must consider three fundamental aspects:

The Abolition of Federalism: The discontent was not exclusive to English-speaking Texans; much of the Texan and Hispanic elite also initially joined the cause to defend state autonomy against the centralist dictatorship.

The Economic Factor and Slavery: The preservation of the slave system was one of the underlying reasons for the settlers of East Texas, as a response to Mexican legislation that threatened its definitive abolition.

Militarization: The siege was an application of Napoleonic doctrine by Santa Anna, who sought a victory of annihilation to demoralize the provisional government of Texas.

Section

Historical Context

The Battle of the Alamo occurred in San Antonio, Texas, from February 23 to March 6, 1836. The Texan volunteer army occupied the Alamo, formerly a Spanish mission named for the surrounding cottonwood trees. The Alamo consisted of three adobe buildings and open plaza areas enclosed by log palisades. It pitted Mexican forces against Texan volunteers during the Texas Revolution. The Texan forces, numbering between 183 and 257 men, occupied the Alamo. They were up against a Mexican army, led by General Antonio López de Santa Anna, with troop estimates ranging from 1,800 to 6,000. The Battle of the Alamo was a military engagement in the Texas Revolution consisting of a 13-day siege. Led by eventual Alamo co-commander James Bowie and William B. Travis, a group of about 200 honorable Texans fought bravely for their federalist freedom.

After Mexico gained its independence from Spain in 1821, the need to protect the northern frontier prompted the new government to establish colonization laws that allowed colonists into Texas. Large groups of people moved to Texas, with the attraction of land and an opportunity to start over. Many of these colonists, along with the native population, enjoyed a semi-autonomous way of life far from the capital in Mexico. However, a year before the battle the Mexican Republic renewed its constitution, adding new policies that entailed restricting or eliminating slavery, limiting immigration from the U.S., and increased enforcement of laws and import tariffs. In addition to that, there was discontent over previous attempts made by the United States to purchase Texas, so the Mexican authorities blamed a large part of the Texan population that was originally from the United States for their issues, claiming that they made little effort to adapt to Mexican culture. This prompted a Mexican Civil War and the Texas independence movement. The Texas Revolution began in October 1835, with Texan victories driving Mexican forces south of the Rio Grande to which Mexico's president, Antonio López de Santa Anna, responded by leading troops into Texas to stop the growing army of settlers, sparking conflict. The Texian army included members of the regular Texas army, militia, and recently arrived volunteers from the United States, they were led by Colonel James Bowie and cavalry officer William B. Travis and David Crockett, a famous U.S. congressman, was among the volunteers. On March 2, 1836, Texas officially declared its independence from Mexico. The Texans fortified the Alamo mission in San Antonio. Santa Anna's army initiated a siege, demanding unconditional surrender, which the Texans rejected, leading to a 13-day bombardment and, ultimately, the Battle of the Alamo.

Sam Houston, the commanding general of the revolutionary army, had earlier left the mission with the main body of his troops, believing it could not be easily defended. Colonel James C. Neill, the acting Alamo commander, wrote to the provisional government: «If there has ever been a dollar here I have no knowledge of it», thanks to him, few reinforcements were authorized. He, however, did not fight in the battle, for he had left the Alamo, determined to recruit additional reinforcements and gather supplies, which is why he ended up transferring his command.

It was a pivotal event in the Texas Revolution. Though resulting in a decisive victory for the Mexican forces and the annihilation of the Texian volunteers, the battle became a symbol of heroic resistance for Texans. The cry, «Remember the Alamo!» became a rallying cry that inspired Texan forces to defeat General Santa Anna at the Battle of San Jacinto on April 21, 1836, securing Texas independence.

Section

Current economical and administrative situation

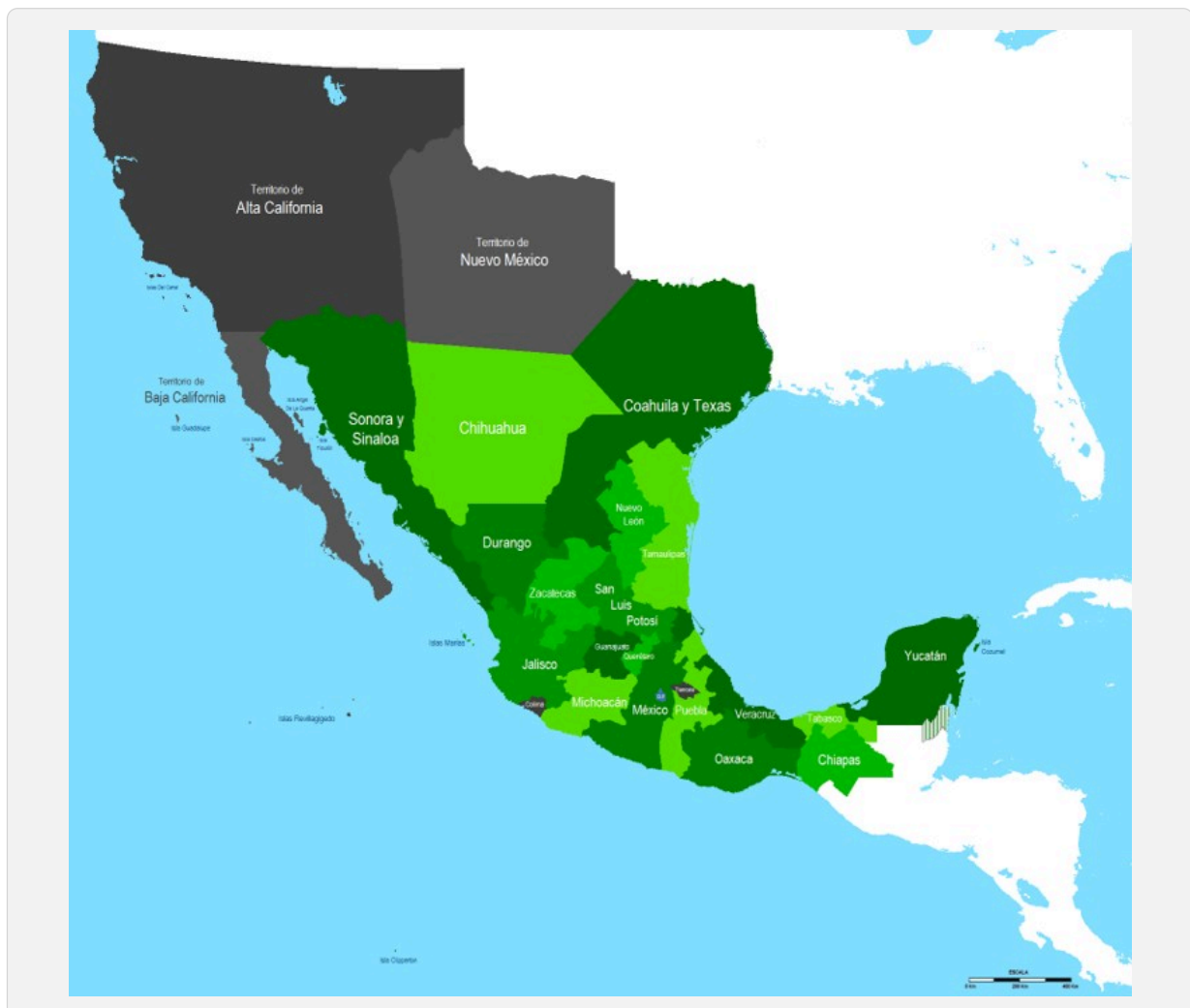
In the years immediately preceding the Battle of the Alamo, the region of Mexican Texas was marked by a fragile and uneven economic structure combined with deep administrative tensions. From the Texan perspective, this environment appeared increasingly restrictive, unstable, and misaligned with their expectations of governance and economic growth, helping explain why conflict escalated so rapidly during 1835.

Economically, Texas in the early 1830s was a frontier region with significant potential but limited infrastructure and uneven development. American settlers had been encouraged to migrate under Santa Ana's emerging centralist system, and many arrived with the expectation of building prosperous agricultural enterprises, particularly cotton plantations. In eastern Texas, this expectation began to materialize when the region developed an export-oriented cotton economy closely tied to markets in the United States, especially through trade connections with Louisiana and New Orleans. However, this growth was uneven. Western areas, including those closer to San Antonio, remained underdeveloped and insecure due to persistent Indigenous raids, which disrupted agriculture, depopulated settlements, and hindered ranching and trade. As a result, much of the region functioned at a subsistence level, with settlers living in isolation and relying on improvised farming and local resources for survival.

Economic indicator	Approximate value (1835)	Source
Approximate value of financing and loans obtained in the United States to support the Texan army	USD\$250,000 authorized in loans. USD\$60,000 received in advances	Barker (1952)
Approximate monthly cost of subsistence and maintenance for the Texan army	Between US\$35,000 per month for supplies, food, transportation and military equipment	Thornton (1917)
Land prices in Texas (settlers)	12,5 cents/acre	Land Grant Records
Land Prices in USA	\$1,25 USD/acre	U.S. Land Act 1820

Economic indicator	Approximate value (1835)	Source
Value of cotton exports in Texas	500.000USD/year	Lack (1992)
Approximate total budget of the revolutionary Texan government	Approximately USD\$495,000	Thornton (1917)

From the Texan viewpoint, economic frustrations were also tied to Mexican regulatory policies. Trade restrictions and customs enforcement, moved by Santa Ana's politics, were perceived as barriers to prosperity, especially since many settlers depended on commercial ties with the United States. Conflicts such as the Anahuac disturbances illustrate how enforcement of tariffs and anti-smuggling measures generated resentment and resistance among settlers, who saw these policies as intrusive and economically harmful. Additionally, Mexico's abolition of slavery in 1829 directly threatened the economic model established in the south of the United States, whose agricultural production relied heavily on enslaved labor. Although some settlers attempted to circumvent these laws, the issue remained a central grievance, reinforcing the perception that Mexican governance was incompatible with their economic interests.



Administratively, tensions were even more pronounced. Texas was part of the larger Mexican state of Coahuila and Texas, a vast and sparsely populated territory that proved difficult to govern effectively. Communication with Mexico City was slow, military presence was limited, and legal institutions were weak. For many settlers, this translated into a sense of neglect and insecurity, particularly in the face of Indigenous raids and local instability. At the same time, the rapid influx of American settlers dramatically altered the demographic balance of the region, with Americans soon outnumbering Mexican-born residents. This demographic shift contributed to cultural and political friction, as many settlers retained strong ties to the United States and were unfamiliar with, or resistant to, Mexican legal and social norms, including Catholicism and centralized authority.

The political situation deteriorated further with the shift from federalism to centralism under Antonio Lopez de Santa Anna. Under the Mexican Constitution of 1824, Texas had enjoyed a degree of local autonomy, which settlers valued. However, Santa Anna's move toward a centralized government in the mid-1830s reduced state powers and increased direct control from Mexico City. From the Texan perspective, this represented a betrayal of earlier agreements and a threat to their political rights. Initially, many settlers sought reforms within the Mexican system, advocating for the restoration of federalism and greater local governance. However, as political instability in Mexico continued, their confidence in the Mexican government eroded. What began as a reform movement gradually shifted toward demands for independence.

Administrative issue	Concrete Manifestation	Consequence
Lack of a consolidated central authority	Disagreements among military and political leaders on the defense of the Alamo mission	Strategic coordination and rapid decision-making were hampered during the siege.
Shortage of supplies and resources	Little ammunition, food, and reinforcements to withstand a prolonged siege	Defensive capabilities gradually decreased in the face of the Mexican army.
Limited communication between Texan forces	The requests sent by William B. Travis took a long time to arrive or received no response.	The defenders of the Alamo were isolated and without sufficient military support in the early stages of the conflict.
Improvised military organization	Troops were volunteers without uniform training or a stable professional structure	Operational discipline decreased and the difficulty of sustaining a coordinated defense increased.
Political division between federalists and independen-	Some combatants sought to restore the 1824 Constitution, while others advocated	Tensions within the internal organization of the revolutionary army due to possible

Administrative issue	Concrete Manifestation	Consequence
	for the complete independence of Texas.	betrayals and dealings with the Mexican government
Economic and logistical dependence on the United States	Much of the supplies, weapons, and trade came from US territory	The revolution had trouble sustaining consistent resources within Texas
Low institutional capacity of the Texas provisional government	The revolutionary government still lacked solid administrative structures and stable funding	The local productive population prioritized running productive businesses over fulfilling revolutionary commitments.

By the eve of the Texas Revolution, the region was characterized by a combination of economic promise and structural weakness, compounded by administrative inefficiency and political mistrust. Sparse population density, limited infrastructure, and ongoing security threats made governance difficult, while rapid immigration and cultural divergence deepened divisions between settlers and Mexican authorities. From the Texan perspective, these conditions justified resistance: they saw themselves as economically constrained, politically marginalized, and increasingly threatened by a centralizing regime. This convergence of economic and administrative grievances set the stage for open rebellion, culminating in key happenings such as the siege and fall of the Alamo in 1836.

Section

Characters

■ Characters-Texan side

1. James Bowie: Military man and merchant who acted as one of the leaders of the Texan side volunteers due to his economic interests.
2. Davy Crockett: Military and political figure, he was part of the United States House of Representatives before joining the volunteer forces under Bowie's command.
3. Albert Martin: Oficial del ejército texano con experiencia previa en milicias locales. Durante la Batalla del Álamo, actuó como mensajero clave, llevando despachos de William B. Travis y apoyando la coordinación defensiva frente al avance mexicano.
4. José Ángel Navarro: A Texan leader with political and military experience in Texas. During the Texas Revolution, he supported the cause as a signatory of the Declaration of Independence and a strategic collaborator, influencing the political organization more than the direct fighting at the Alamo.
5. Lorenzo de Zavala: Politician and diplomat with federalist ideals. He sought to legitimize Texan independence and acted as a liaison between Texas and Mexico. He was in charge of drafting official documents for the Texan revolutionaries.
6. Edward Burleson: Businessman, military officer, and commander in the Texas Army. A key figure in the early Texan resistance efforts under Sam Houston. Known for his *modus operandi* based on swift and efficient action and his close relationship with his troops.
7. Juan Nepomuceno Seguín: Politician and military man, critic of the Santa Anna government, which is why he ventured to fight in the revolution for Texan independence.
8. Samuel Maverick: Texas lawyer, landowner, and ideological promoter of Texas independence.
9. Henry Karnes: A soldier of the Republic of Texas, born in Tennessee. He participated in the Texas Revolution, distinguishing himself in battles such as Concepción, Béxar, and San Jacinto, where he fought against Mexican and Comanche forces.
10. Thomas J. Rusk: Military y político texano.
11. Sidney Sherman: Coronel del ejército texano que lideró un regimiento de voluntarios durante la Revolución de Texas.
12. Green DeWitt: Empresario y empresario colonizador angloamericano. Aunque no tuvo un papel militar destacado, fue uno de los principales promotores de la colonización de Texas y apoyó la causa independentista mediante recursos y organización.
13. Robert Evans: Militar texano y miembro de la guarnición del Álamo.
14. John W. Smith: Mensajero y explorador de la guarnición del Álamo.

15. Dr John Sutherland: Veterano del ejército texano que participó en la campaña de Texas y en las operaciones alrededor de Béxar.

■ Characters - Mexican Side

1. Martín Perfecto de Cos: A Spanish military officer in the service of Mexico with experience in internal conflicts. During the Battle of the Alamo, he commanded Mexican forces under Antonio López de Santa Anna, participating in the siege and final assault.
2. Manuel Fernández Castrillón: A Cuban-born military officer who was a close friend of Santa Anna. He was his aide-de-camp in the Texas War of Independence, where he also played a significant role in leading the Toluca Battalion, succeeding Francisco Duque.
3. Nicolás Bravo: A Mexican military officer and politician of traditionalist persuasion, he defended Mexican unity and territorial control. Leader of the Army of the Center, he led the defense of Chapultepec Castle in the Battle of Chapultepec. He served as Vice President and Interim President of Mexico before the Texas War of Independence.
4. Juan Nepomuceno Almonte: Almonte was one of the officers who assisted Antonio López de Santa Anna during the Texas War of Independence. He participated in the Battle of the Alamo, being one of the officers who unsuccessfully appealed for the seven defenders captured alive, among whom was Davy Crockett.
5. Francisco Duque: Mexican commander in charge of planning and executing sieges to maintain order in the disputed territory.
6. Agustín Amat: Military officer who served in the Mexican forces during the Texas campaign. He participated in army operations in the north under the command of Antonio López de Santa Anna, contributing to actions such as the siege of the Alamo.
7. Pedro Ampudia: Pedro Nolasco Martín José María de la Candelaria Francisco Javier Ampudia y Grimarest was born in Havana, Cuba, and served Mexico as an officer in the Army of the North for most of his life. He served as governor of Tabasco, Yucatán, and Nuevo León at various times.
8. José Vicente Miñón: He was a Spanish-Mexican military officer born in Cádiz in 1802. He arrived in New Spain as a member of the royalist army, but after the Embrace of Acatempan, he joined the Army of the Three Guarantees and participated in the capture of Mexico City.
9. Juan José Andrade: He was commander of a cavalry brigade under Antonio López de Santa Anna during the Texas Revolution. After the Battle of the Alamo, he was given command of Béxar in 1836. That same year, in May, on Filisola's orders, he demolished the Alamo and marched toward Goliad.
10. Vicente Filisola: General italiano al servicio de México.
11. Joaquín Ramírez y Sesma: General mexicano encargado de dirigir la vanguardia del Ejército de Operaciones en Texas.
12. Francisco Bercera: Coronel del ejército mexicano que participó en las operaciones de la campaña texana bajo el mando de Santa Anna.
13. Juan Amador: Ingeniero militar mexicano responsable de realizar reconocimientos del terreno.
14. Antonio Gaona: General de brigada del ejército mexicano con experiencia en campañas internacionales.

Section

Special Procedure

Due to the warlike nature of the committee, we will use a phased system similar to the game of Risk, where delegates must focus on different objectives depending on the phase they are in. The phases are Recruitment/Organization, Attack on the opposing side, and Reorganization of territory and troops.

Recruitment/Organization: During this phase, the delegates must recruit their troops, organize their arsenal, and prepare their base for an enemy siege. The objective during this phase is to quantify their war resources and provide a qualitative description of their condition.

Attack on opposing side: During this phase, the delegates must design and execute a siege plan, as well as gather intelligence on the opposing side in order to launch an attack that can effectively disrupt the enemy's organization. They must also aim to conquer and expand their control over the disputed territory.

Territory and Troop Reorganization: In this phase, the damaged territory must be rebuilt, and solutions must be found for the health of wounded combatants. Depending on the quality of actions during each attack phase, one delegate should die. This is at the discretion of the command center and depends on each delegate's individual reserved health.

As a second dynamic, we will have a reputation system similar to the video game Red Dead Redemption 2. Based on the quality of public and private directives, army morale and the self-perception and external perception of each delegate can be modified. Therefore, for this committee, all directives will be in digital format. If an individual's reputation reaches 0, the delegate will die.

Thirdly, we will have a random system using a deck of poker cards to answer certain private and public directives. This can alter the quality of the response to varying degrees of approval. The use of this dynamic will be at the discretion of the command center, although delegates may request to use it if they find it necessary or entertaining. For this activity, the types of card games will be: High Card, Blackjack, Draw Poker.

Section

What's expected from the committee?

First and foremost, as your DAIS we want this committee to be a place where we can all grow and learn new things. We want you to push yourselves to develop new abilities that will accompany you throughout your whole life also having fun and enjoying the journey that MONUA can be

That being said, of course we expect to see the Texan side victory, and for that to happen you need to be well informed and ready to fight, this is not a peaceful diplomatic committee, this is about your Texan pride and independence. Please study this guide thoroughly and do your own research, historical knowledge and appropriation will be key.

From the strategy center's perspective, we will value quality over quantity. Therefore, whether your approach to delegating to crisis committees results in drafting a few lengthy directives, or a large number of shorter ones, will be irrelevant to your evaluation. What matters to us is your development, adaptability, and the creativity you demonstrate. It's important to clarify that, since you will be evaluation matrices based on sessions, you must submit at least one public and one private document per session to avoid empty spaces in the matrix.

Section

Qarmas

- How will you handle the management of the men fighting for the Texan side?
- What kind of alliances can be made to fortify the army?
- What role does your character play in fulfilling the Texans' objectives?
- Can the army's underdog status help your reputation? Will it compel other people to join you?
- Will victory signify something greater for the nation? How would that affect your character's life?
- What will happen if a decision made by the Texan side has a negative collateral effect on the entire revolution?
- How can you justify the need for enslaved labor as a key motive behind the revolution?

Section

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